



TECHUNITED:NJ • FALL 2026

UPLIFT EXPERT SESSIONS

Share your expertise.

We are looking for **22 experts** to give back to Uplift through 30 minute virtual sessions, September 11 to November 4. Streamed directly to the founders in our program, then shared on LinkedIn, posted to YouTube, and clipped for you to post.

APPLY HERE

uplift2026.vercel.app/share-your-expertise

About seven minutes. Questions: uplift@techunited.co

~70 founders in the program

~30 attend live

3 sessions a week

12:30 or 5:30 ET

up to 3 sessions each

speak from anywhere

THE CONTEXT

What Uplift is, and what a session is

The program

TechUnited:NJ's founder mentorship program. Eight weeks, around 70 vetted New Jersey founders, each matched with a mentor.

The sessions

Three a week, 30 minutes, all virtual. 22 of them between September 11 and November 4, at 12:30 or 5:30 ET. Speakers join from anywhere, so only the time slot has to work.

The room

Everyone is welcome at every session and about 30 come live. Founders need three to complete the program.

THE BRIEF

What would you talk about?

30 minutes, virtual, with time for founder questions. Almost anything a founder can act on works: if they can use it on Monday, it fits. Repeats of anything below are welcome, the founders are entirely different this program.

PROPOSE A FORMAT we confirm the details with you on a call

Presentation
You teach with slides, then take questions.

Fireside chat
We interview you, founders ask questions.

Working session
Founders bring their own work, you coach live.

Something else
Propose your own, and tell us how it runs.

IDEAS TO START FROM none required

Automating with AI
one real workflow

Defining your ICP
who to sell to, and who to stop

Pitching yourself
what actually lands

Public speaking
for founders who dread it

Mistakes you made
told honestly

How you built it
the unglamorous years

Your daily playbook
what they should copy

Your own subject
if they can use it, it fits

WHAT OUR LAST PROGRAM RAN fair game to repeat

How to Pitch an Angel
What investors actually look for
Joanne Wilson, Gotham Gal Ventures

Inside Angel Investing
Building relationships before you raise
Gina Tedesco, Golden Seed Ventures

Service as Strategy
Customer experience as competitive edge
Christina Perla, Makelab

Beyond the Logo
A brand customers trust and investors understand
Debra Rizzi

Earning the Room
Visibility, credibility, and access
Chrissy Buteas

The Gap Between an Idea and a Customer
Getting from one to the other
Tom Sauer, Mile Square Labs

Pattern Recognition = Pivot Fuel
Reading your own signals
Mark Nelson, Foodie Box Love

Pitch Without a Deck
Founders on the spot
Peer workshop

THE FORM

What we will ask you for

About seven minutes. No deck required, and your existing bio is fine. If you already mentor with Uplift or we invited you, this is not an audition: you have priority, and the form is how we settle your date. Once confirmed you get an email with that date, a calendar invite holding the slot, and a 15 minute planning call. Everyone hears back within one business day.

- headshot
- short bio
- proposed title
- what you would cover
- who it is for
- resources or tools you would share
- three dates, ranked 1 to 3

THE TRADE

What you get

The room

- 30 minutes with founders who chose your session
- Live questions from people building right now
- Up to three sessions if you want a series
- Priority on these slots if you already mentor with Uplift

The reach after it

- Shared on LinkedIn, posted to YouTube
- We clip it and send you the clips to post
- Your name, headshot, company, and links on all of it

Free, and no pitch expected.

THE DATES

Available dates

The form asks for up to three different dates in order, first, second, third. Your first choice wins if it is open. You can be based anywhere, Atlanta, Chicago, New York, California, New Jersey, since everything runs virtual. Times below are Eastern, so check they land for you.

SESSION 1 Fri Sept 11 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 2 Mon Sept 14 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 3 Tue Sept 15 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 4 Fri Sept 18 12:30 PM ET open
SESSION 5 Mon Sept 21 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 6 Tue Sept 22 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 7 Fri Sept 25 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 8 Mon Sept 28 12:30 PM ET open
SESSION 9 Tue Sept 29 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 10 Fri Oct 2 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 11 Mon Oct 5 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 12 Tue Oct 6 5:30 PM ET open
SESSION 13 Fri Oct 9 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 14 Mon Oct 12 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 15 Fri Oct 16 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 16 Mon Oct 19 12:30 PM ET open
SESSION 17 Tue Oct 20 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 18 Tue Oct 20 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 19 Wed Oct 21 12:30 PM ET open	SESSION 20 Fri Oct 23 5:30 PM ET open
SESSION 21 Tue Nov 3 5:30 PM ET open	SESSION 22 Wed Nov 4 12:30 PM ET open		

22 of 22 slots still open. Updated every few minutes, so a date can go while you are filling the form. Rank five and you are covered.

ONE LINK, SEVEN MINUTES

Send the elevator back down

If you have done the thing, put your name in. We review every application within one business day.

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